

UPSC GS-II POLITY

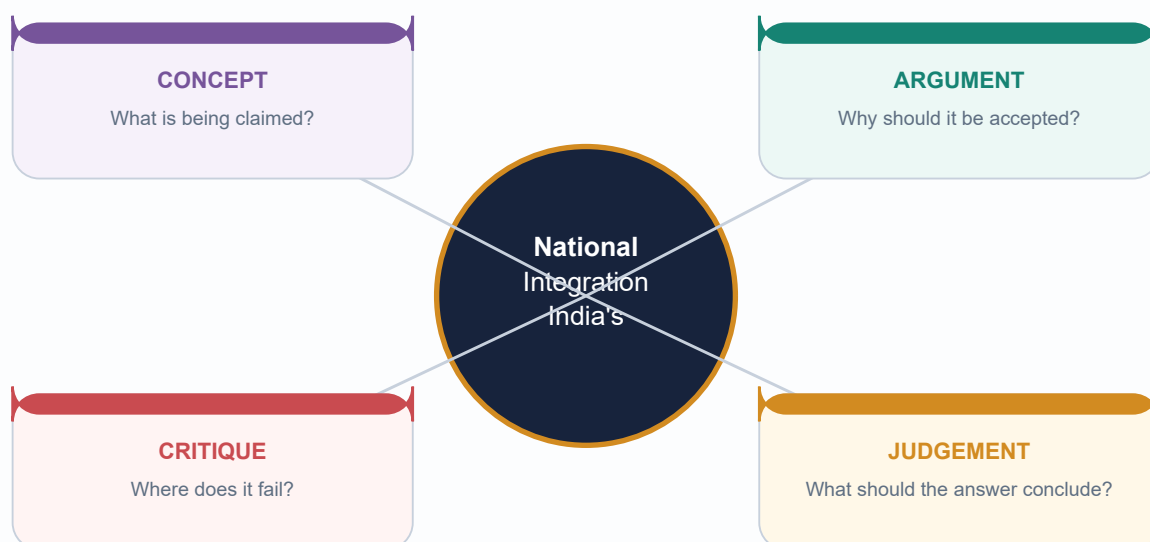
National Integration and India's Foreign Policy

Integrated Basic + Advanced Course

10 deep-learning modules | National Integration Council to Voice of the Global South

Visual timelines, institutional maps, comparisons, UPSC traps and Mains frameworks

Prepared from the verified Polity knowledge base (Laxmikant Ch. 78-79) and the completed guided session



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

1. National Integration: Meaning and Obstacles

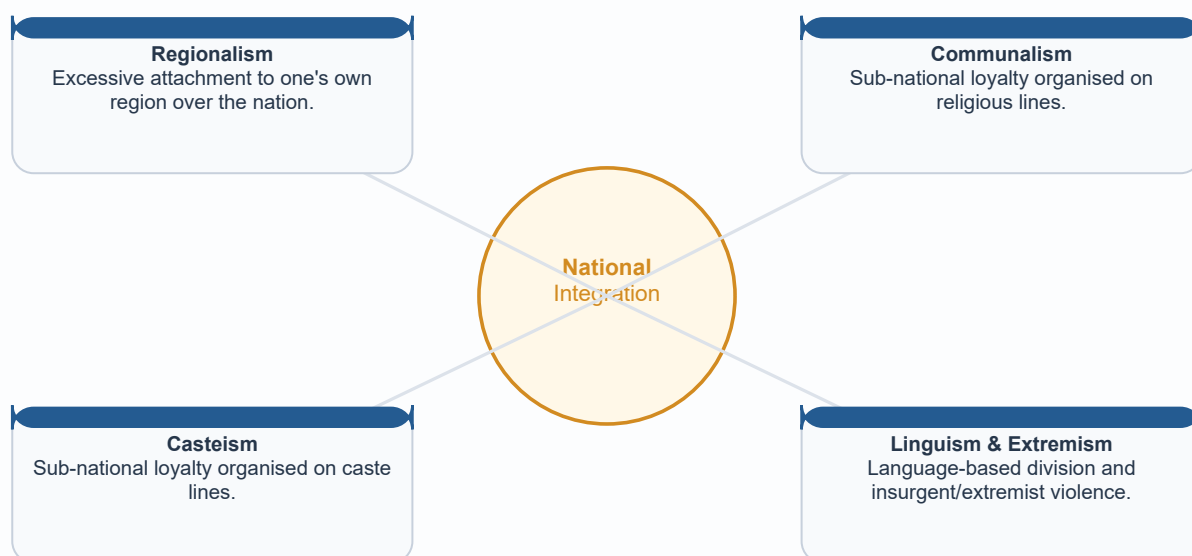
GS-I / GS-II
Polity - National
Unity

INTRO & ORIGIN

National integration is the sense of oneness and unity that overrides divisive identities of region, religion, caste and language. It is the psychological and emotional cohesion that binds a diverse society into one political community.

Laxmikant frames national integration as a continuous process threatened by specific, nameable obstacles rather than as a completed, static achievement.

OBSTACLES TO NATIONAL INTEGRATION



STATIC THEORY

- National integration is best tested against its named threats: regionalism, communalism, casteism, linguism and extremism/insurgency.
- The National Integration Council (Module 2) is the institutional response to exactly these threats.

MEMORY HOOK

Unity above region, religion, caste, language.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. National integration means a sense of oneness overriding region, religion, caste and language.
2. Its principal obstacles are regionalism, communalism, casteism, linguism and extremism.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: National integration is a one-time achievement marked by Independence in 1947.

CORRECT: It is a continuous process, contested afresh by recurring regional, communal, caste and linguistic pressures.

MAINS ANGLE

Frame any answer on communal/regional tension by first naming which of the five obstacles it represents, then link to the institutional response.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> National Integration -> Obstacles -> NIC Architecture (Module 2)

HIGH

2. National Integration Council (NIC): Institutional Architecture

GS-II Polity -
Advisory
Institutions

INTRO & ORIGIN

The National Integration Council (NIC) was established in 1961, after a 'unity in diversity' conference under Nehru, to combat communalism, casteism and regionalism and to recommend measures for national unity.

It is an extra-constitutional, non-statutory advisory body chaired by the Prime Minister.

KEY DATA

Feature	Detail
Nature	Extra-constitutional, non-statutory advisory body
Established	1961, after a 'unity in diversity' conference under Nehru
Chair	Prime Minister
Membership (2010)	147 - Union Ministers, Leaders of Opposition, all Chief Ministers, party leaders, commission chairs, eminent public figures
Mandate	Combat communalism, casteism and regionalism; recommend measures for national unity

STATIC THEORY

- The NIC is advisory only - it has no statutory or constitutional force behind its recommendations.
- It has been reconstituted repeatedly with growing membership, reflecting an attempt to widen representation rather than to strengthen enforcement power.

MEMORY HOOK

NIC = advisory, NOT constitutional or statutory.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The NIC was established in 1961 and is chaired by the Prime Minister.
2. It is an extra-constitutional, non-statutory advisory body.
3. Its 2010 membership stood at 147.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The NIC is a constitutional body created by a specific Article.

CORRECT: It is extra-constitutional and non-statutory - purely advisory in character.

MAINS ANGLE

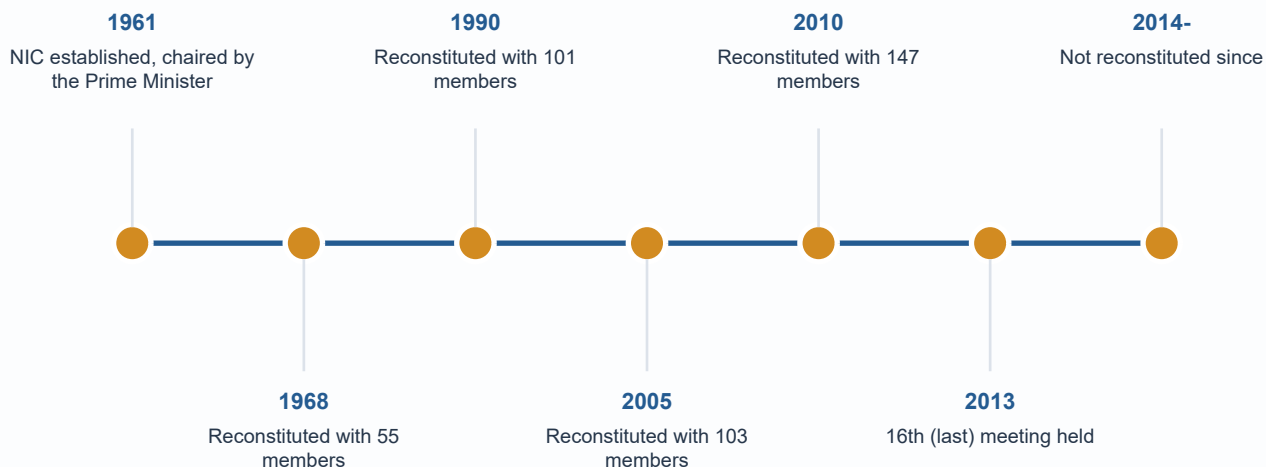
Use the NIC's advisory-only character to explain why its recommendations have historically 'remained only on paper'.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> National Integration -> NIC
Architecture -> NIC Status Today (Module 3)

HIGH**3. NIC Status: From Reconstitution to a Defunct Body**GS-II Polity -
Institutional
Effectiveness /
Current Affairs**NEWS TRIGGER**

The NIC is effectively defunct: its last (16th) meeting was in 2013, and it has not been reconstituted since 2014.

NIC RECONSTITUTION AND DECLINE**STATIC THEORY**

- The growth in membership over time (55 → 101 → 103 → 147) did not translate into greater effectiveness - the NIC has been consistently criticised as ineffective.
- Its recommendations are widely described as having 'remained only on paper'.

MEMORY HOOK

Last met 2013. Not reconstituted since 2014.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The NIC's 16th and last meeting was held in 2013.
2. It has not been reconstituted since 2014.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The NIC continues to meet regularly to address current communal/regional tensions.

CORRECT: It is effectively defunct - no meeting since 2013 and no reconstitution since 2014.

MAINS ANGLE

'Is the National Integration Council still relevant? Suggest institutional reforms for managing India's diversity.' - use the defunct status as the empirical hook.

STUDY LINK

Polity → National Integration → NIC Status → Foreign Policy Basis (Module 4)

HIGH

4. Constitutional Basis of Foreign Policy: Article 51 (DPSP)

GS-II Polity -
Constitutional
Foundations of
Diplomacy

INTRO & ORIGIN

India's foreign policy flows from Article 51, a Directive Principle of State Policy, which directs the State to promote international peace and security.

Nehru framed peace as 'an emergent necessity' - not a moral add-on but a structural requirement of India's foreign policy.

ARTICLE 51: WHAT THE DIRECTIVE REQUIRES

1. Promote international peace and security

The State shall endeavour to maintain world peace.



2. Maintain honourable relations

Just and honourable relations between nations.



3. Respect international law and treaties

Foster respect for international law and treaty obligations.



4. Encourage arbitration

Encourage settlement of international disputes by arbitration.

STATIC THEORY

- Article 51 is a DPSP - not judicially enforceable, but it is the constitutional anchor cited for the entire foreign-policy chapter.
- The article's four elements (peace, honourable relations, respect for law/treaties, arbitration) map directly onto later principles like Panchsheel and support to the UN.

MEMORY HOOK

Foreign policy is NOT policy-free of the Constitution - Article 51 (DPSP) is its base.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Article 51 is the constitutional (DPSP) basis of India's foreign policy.
2. It calls for world peace, honourable inter-state relations, respect for international law/treaties, and settlement of disputes by arbitration.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: India's foreign policy has no constitutional basis at all.

CORRECT: Article 51 (a DPSP) provides the directive foundation for foreign policy.

MAINS ANGLE

Cite Article 51 explicitly whenever a question asks for the constitutional basis of any foreign-policy principle - examiners reward the specific article.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Foreign Policy -> Article 51 -> Panchsheel (Module 5)

HIGH

5. Panchsheel: The Five Principles

GS-II Polity -
Foreign Policy
Principles

NEWS TRIGGER

Panchsheel dates to the 1954 Indo-China Treaty on Tibet (Nehru-Zhou Enlai) - a foundational text for India's approach to inter-state relations.

PANCHSHEEL - FIVE PRINCIPLES (1954, INDO-CHINA TREATY)

Panchsheel

1. Territorial Integrity Mutual respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity.	2. Non-Aggression Mutual non-aggression between states.
3. Non-Interference Non-interference in each other's internal affairs.	4. Equality & Mutual Benefit Equality and mutual benefit in relations.
5. Peaceful Co-existence Peaceful co-existence between states of different systems.	

STATIC THEORY

- Panchsheel was signed in the 1954 Indo-China Treaty concerning Tibet, negotiated by Nehru and Zhou Enlai.
- It is the single most frequently tested foreign-policy principle in Prelims - the year (1954) and the counterpart (China, not the USSR) are the two facts most often mistested.

MEMORY HOOK

Panchsheel = 1954 + China (Tibet Treaty) + Nehru-Zhou Enlai.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Panchsheel has five principles, agreed in the 1954 Indo-China Treaty on Tibet.
2. The agreement was between Nehru and Zhou Enlai.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Panchsheel was signed with the USSR.

CORRECT: It was signed with China in 1954 (the Tibet Treaty), between Nehru and Zhou Enlai.

MAINS ANGLE

Panchsheel remains citable as the normative basis for India's positions on sovereignty and non-interference in contemporary disputes.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Foreign Policy -> Panchsheel -> Full List of Nine Principles (Module 6)

HIGH

6. The Nine Principles of Indian Foreign Policy

GS-II Polity -
Foreign Policy
Principles

KEY DATA

#	Principle	Key Point
1	World Peace	Rooted in Article 51; Nehru: 'peace is an emergent necessity'
2	Anti-Colonialism	Supported Afro-Asian liberation movements
3	Anti-Racialism	Opposed apartheid; snapped ties with South Africa in 1954
4	Non-Alignment	No military bloc; independent foreign policy; friendship with all
5	Panchsheel	Five principles, 1954 Indo-China Treaty on Tibet (Nehru-Zhou Enlai)
6	Afro-Asian Bias	Bandung 1955; G-77, G-15, IOR-ARC, BIMSTEC, SAARC (1985)
7	Commonwealth	Voluntary member since 1949 - does not affect republican status
8	Support to the UN	Member since 1945; peacekeeping; demands a permanent UNSC seat
9	Disarmament	Did NOT sign the NPT (1968) or CTBT (1996) - calls them discriminatory

STATIC THEORY

- This nine-point list is Laxmikanth's own structure and is the highest-yield version for both Prelims recall and Mains enumeration.
- Note the internal logic: principles 1-3 are normative commitments, 4-6 are strategic postures, 7-9 are institutional/treaty stances.

MEMORY HOOK

Nine principles, three clusters: values -> strategy -> institutions.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. India snapped ties with South Africa in 1954 over apartheid.
2. India has been a voluntary Commonwealth member since 1949, without affecting its republican status.
3. India did not sign the NPT (1968) or the CTBT (1996).

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: India cut ties with South Africa in 1947, at Independence.

CORRECT: The break came in 1954, specifically over apartheid.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the nine-principle list as a checklist to ensure a comprehensive foreign-policy answer does not omit any cluster (values, strategy, institutions).

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Foreign Policy -> Nine Principles -> Non-Alignment to Multi-Alignment (Module 7)

HIGH

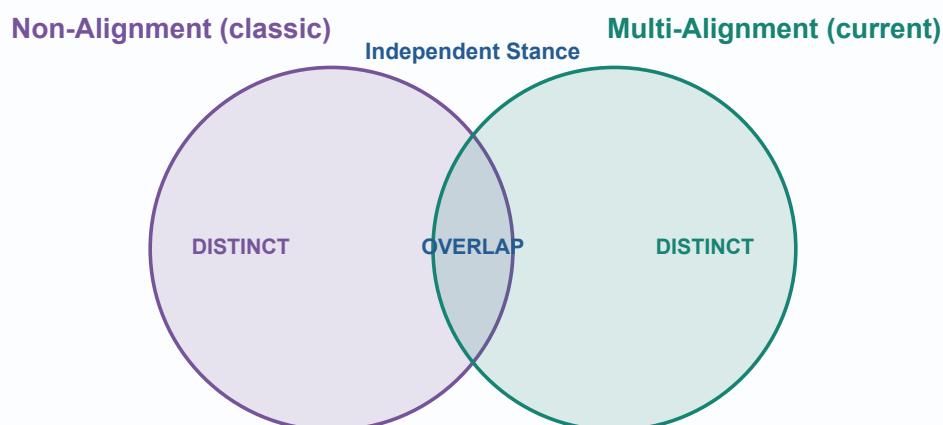
7. Non-Alignment to Multi-Alignment / Strategic Autonomy

GS-II Polity -
Evolution of
Foreign Policy /
Current Affairs

NEWS TRIGGER

India today simultaneously engages QUAD, SCO, BRICS and I2U2 - a shift External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar has framed as 'multi-alignment' or strategic autonomy.

NON-ALIGNMENT ERA VS MULTI-ALIGNMENT/STRATEGIC AUTONOMY



Non-Alignment (classic)

- No military bloc membership
- Bandung 1955; NAM founding
- Friendship with all blocs during the Cold War

Independent Stance

- Independent, not neutral, stance
- National interest as the guiding compass
- Freedom from binding bloc discipline

Multi-Alignment (current)

- Simultaneous QUAD, SCO, BRICS, I2U2 engagement
- Issue-based, transactional partnerships
- Framed by S. Jaishankar as strategic autonomy

The instrument changed from bloc-avoidance to multi-forum engagement; the underlying principle of independence did not.

STATIC THEORY

- Non-alignment means an independent stance, not neutrality or non-involvement - India actively engaged on decolonisation, disarmament and peacekeeping even while avoiding blocs.
- Multi-alignment/strategic autonomy is the widely used framing (□□ inference from official-source current affairs) for India's simultaneous membership of multiple, sometimes competing, groupings.

MEMORY HOOK

NAM = independent, NOT neutral. Multi-alignment = independent, NOT exclusive.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Non-alignment means an independent foreign-policy stance, not neutrality.
2. India today engages QUAD, SCO, BRICS and I2U2 simultaneously.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Non-alignment means strict neutrality or isolation from world affairs.

CORRECT: It means an independent stance with active engagement, not neutrality or non-involvement.

MAINS ANGLE

'Non-alignment to multi-alignment' - trace this evolution and its implication for India's strategic autonomy in a multipolar world.

STUDY LINK

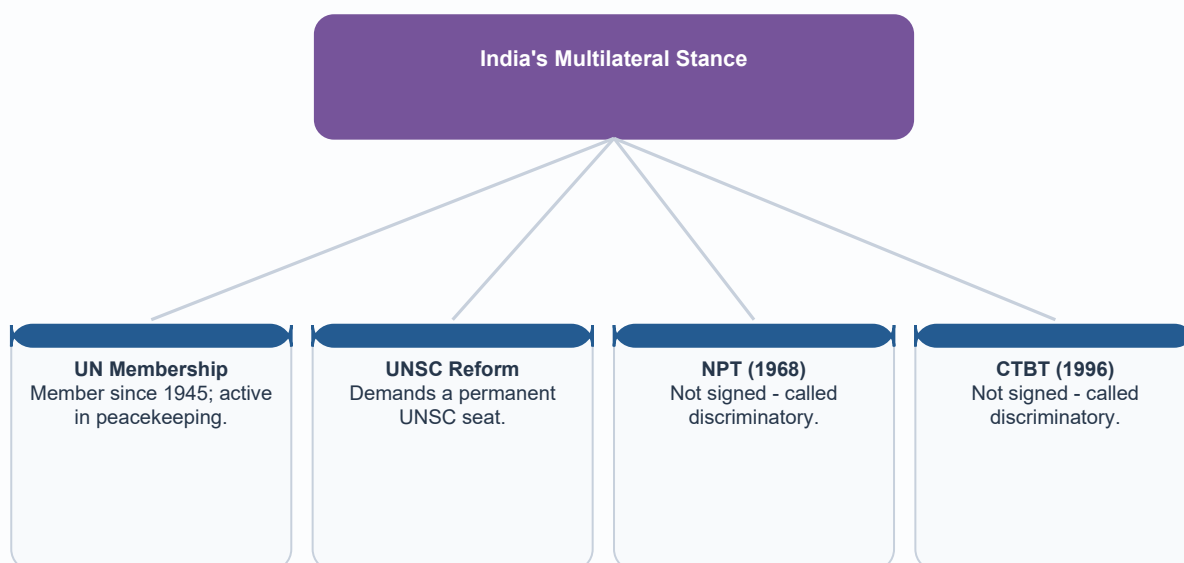
Polity -> Foreign Policy -> Multi-Alignment -> UN & Disarmament Stance (Module 8)

HIGH

8. India, the United Nations, and the Disarmament Stance

GS-II Polity -
Multilateral
Engagement

INDIA'S UN AND DISARMAMENT POSITION



STATIC THEORY

- India frames its refusal to sign the NPT and CTBT as a rejection of a discriminatory global order that entrenches existing nuclear-weapon states while restricting others.
- Support to the UN (membership since 1945, active peacekeeping) sits alongside the demand for UNSC reform - India backs the institution while seeking a bigger seat within it.

MEMORY HOOK

Neither NPT nor CTBT signed - both are called 'discriminatory'.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

- India has been a UN member since 1945.
- India has not signed the NPT (1968) or the CTBT (1996).
- India continues to press for a permanent UNSC seat.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: India has signed the NPT but not the CTBT.

CORRECT: India has not signed either treaty.

MAINS ANGLE

Link the NPT/CTBT non-signature to the broader 'Voice of the Global South' framing - India positions itself against a discriminatory global order on multiple fronts.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Foreign Policy -> UN & Disarmament
-> Voice of the Global South (Module 9)

HIGH

9. India as the Voice of the Global South: G20 2023

GS-II Polity -
Current Affairs /
Global
Diplomacy

NEWS TRIGGER

India's 2023 G20 Presidency produced the New Delhi Declaration and secured permanent G20 membership for the African Union - positioning India as a bridge power and host of the 'Voice of the Global South' summits.

G20 2023 AND THE GLOBAL SOUTH FRAMING



STATIC THEORY

- The African Union's induction as a permanent G20 member is presented as India's signature Presidency achievement, extending the G20's representative base.
- The 'Voice of the Global South' framing continues India's historic Afro-Asian bias (Bandung 1955, G-77, NAM) in a contemporary multilateral setting.

MEMORY HOOK

G20 2023 = New Delhi Declaration + African Union (permanent member) + Global South voice.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. India held the G20 Presidency in 2023, producing the New Delhi Declaration.
2. The African Union was made a permanent G20 member during India's Presidency.
3. India has hosted 'Voice of the Global South' summits.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The 'Voice of the Global South' initiative is a new institution replacing NAM.

CORRECT: It is a summit-format diplomatic initiative, not a formal replacement for the Non-Aligned Movement or any treaty body.

MAINS ANGLE

'India as the Voice of the Global South': opportunities and constraints in a multipolar world - use the G20 2023 Presidency as the concrete anchor.

STUDY LINK

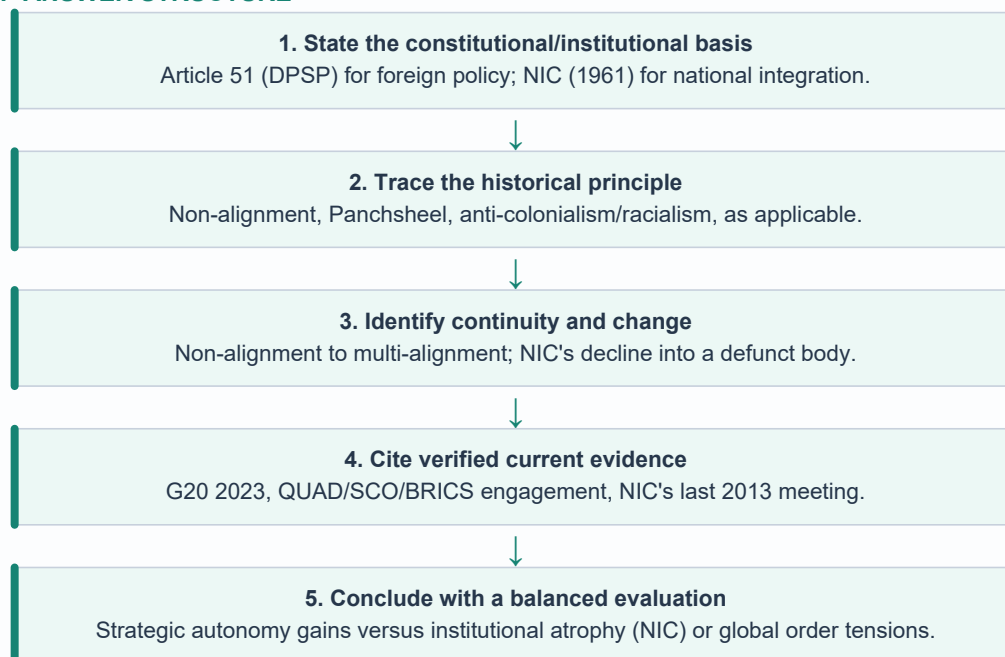
Polity -> Foreign Policy -> Voice of the Global South -> Mains Framework (Module 10)

HIGH

10. UPSC Mains Answer-Writing Framework: National Integration & Foreign Policy

GS-I / GS-II
Polity - Answer
Framework

FIVE-STEP ANSWER STRUCTURE



STATIC THEORY

- Mains angle 1: 'Non-alignment to multi-alignment' - trace the evolution of India's foreign policy and its strategic autonomy.
- Mains angle 2: Is the National Integration Council still relevant? Suggest institutional reforms for managing India's diversity.
- Mains angle 3: India as the 'Voice of the Global South': opportunities and constraints in a multipolar world.

MEMORY HOOK

Basis -> History -> Continuity/Change -> Current Evidence -> Balanced Conclusion.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Always cite Article 51 for foreign policy and the NIC (1961) for national integration as the opening constitutional/institutional anchors.
2. Pair every historical principle with a current-affairs example (G20 2023, QUAD/SCO/BRICS, NIC's defunct status) to show continuity and change.

MAINS ANGLE

This five-step spine fits both institutional-effectiveness questions (NIC) and foreign-policy evolution questions (non-alignment to multi-alignment) equally well.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> National Integration & Foreign Policy
-> Complete -> Emergency Provisions
(companion chapter)